TESSA LINDQVIST

Head of Community | Champions and Ambassador Programs, Developer Communities, PLG to Enterprise Expansion

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SUMMARY

Community leader with 13 years building community as a growth lever at companies running PLG and enterprise sales motions at the same time. Lead a global team of 14 program owners and regional leads across North America, EMEA, and Japan/APAC, accountable for retained users, product adoption, and enterprise expansion. Replaced activity metrics with a measurement framework built with Product and Data Science, segmenting the base from non-user to occasional to high-value daily, and put my name on community-sourced retention and expansion in every QBR. Built a recognized champions program that turned power users inside accounts into org-wide adoption, and unified training, certification, and community help into one path to skill-building. Equally at home with a Staff engineer and a CIO.

CORE SKILLS

Global community strategy and operating models, audience thesis and program portfolio, central versus in-region design, team leadership and hiring, measurement frameworks (cohorting, attribution, usage segmentation), retained users and product adoption, champions, ambassadors, and train-the-trainer programs, partner ecosystems, Sales and CS account plan integration, training, certification, and enablement, developer relations, launch programs, Brand and Comms partnership, community trust through hard moments.

Tools: Snowflake, Looker, Amplitude, dbt, Salesforce, Gainsight, Common Room, Discourse, Slack, Discord, Bevy, Thinkific.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Community | Fieldnote AI (AI developer platform with self-serve and enterprise tiers) | San Francisco, CA | April 2022 to Present

Own global community strategy and the operating model: audience thesis, a portfolio of 9 programs, and a clear split between what is built centrally and what regional leads run in-region.

Lead and coach a distributed team of 14 program owners and regional leads in North America, EMEA, and Japan/APAC, scaled from 4; hired the gaps, set the bar, and developed community-native operators.

Partnered with Product and Data Science to define usage quality, instrument it, and segment the base (non-user, occasional, high-value daily); community-engaged users retain at 1.8x the rate of matched non-participants at day 90.

Architected the champions, train-the-trainer, and partner motions that turn power users inside accounts into org-wide adoption; 310 enterprise champions now run internal enablement, and accounts with an active champion expand seats 2.3x faster.

Integrated champion signals into Sales and CS strategic account plans; community-sourced expansion pipeline reached $41M in FY2025, reported quarterly in the revenue QBR.

Brought training, certification, enablement, and community help into one learning path; 62,000 users certified, and certified users reach daily active use 40 percent faster.

Built programs and voice tuned to developers, knowledge workers, and executive sponsors without fragmenting the experience, including a 2,800 member developer Discord and a 120 member executive council.

Own community's job pre-launch, at launch, and post-launch for every major release and the 2024 pricing and packaging change; partnered with Comms through that change and an extended outage, holding community sentiment above 70 percent positive.

Director, Developer Community and Champions | Brightwave Data (API-first data infrastructure) | San Francisco, CA | March 2018 to March 2022

Built the Brightwave Champions program, later profiled in industry case studies, growing from 40 to 1,100 champions across 38 countries.

Stood up community in-region for EMEA and Japan, hiring the first regional leads and localizing programs while keeping a single global standard.

Built the community measurement plumbing (event tracking, cohort tables, attribution to activation and paid conversion) that the company still runs; community-touched signups converted to paid at 2.1x.

Senior Manager, Customer Advocacy and Education | Northpeak Software (enterprise SaaS) | Seattle, WA | June 2014 to February 2018

Ran customer marketing, advocacy, and customer education for 4,000 enterprise accounts; launched a certification program that reached 15,000 certified admins and cut onboarding support tickets 28 percent.

Developer Relations Engineer | Pylon Labs | Seattle, WA | August 2011 to May 2014

Built sample apps, docs, and SDK tutorials and ran meetups for an API-first developer community, earning credibility with technical audiences early in my career.

SPEAKING AND RECOGNITION

Speaker at CMX Summit and DevRelCon on measuring community by retention and expansion. Community Industry Report contributor on champions programs.

EDUCATION AND ADDITIONAL

B.A. Communication, University of Washington. Worked in Stockholm and Tokyo for regional launches; conversational Swedish and basic Japanese.